

Bogotá D.C., Colombia, August 18, 2026

Bundesagentur für Arbeit
German Federal Employment Agency

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

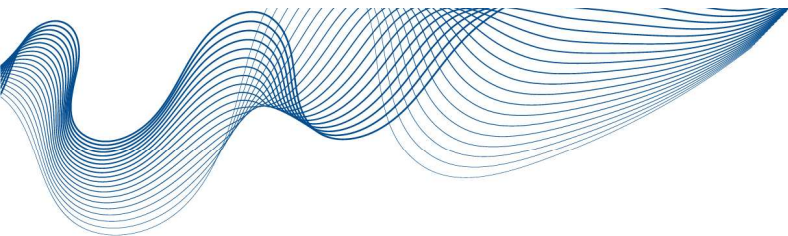
Re: Institutional Certification Regarding the Academic Status and Curricular Recognition of the International Professional Internship of Mr. Andrés Patricio Rivera Benavides, Civil Engineering Program (KOSPIE 2025–2026)

I write in my capacity as Dean of the Faculty of Civil Engineering of Universidad Santo Tomás (Bogotá, Colombia), at the request of Mr. Andrés Patricio Rivera Benavides, a student currently enrolled in our Civil Engineering undergraduate program, in connection with additional documentation requested by the German Federal Employment Agency regarding his participation in the KOSPIE 2025–2026 program in Germany. The purpose of this letter is to accurately describe, for the Agency's records, the academic nature of professional internships within our curriculum and the institutional process governing their recognition.

In the interest of full and precise disclosure, the Faculty confirms that professional internships are not, in and of themselves, a mandatory graduation requirement applicable to every student of the Civil Engineering program. Rather, they constitute an optional academic modality that a student may elect during their studies, governed by the Faculty's Internal Regulations on Professional Practices and Internships and by the University's Student Regulations.

When a student chooses to pursue this modality, the internship is not merely an extracurricular activity: it is formally integrated into the student's academic plan of study through a homologation process. Specifically, the internship, once reviewed and approved by the Faculty's Committee on Professional Practices and Internships, is credited as equivalent to two (2) academic elective/emphasis course spaces within the student's curriculum. Because this process entails the execution of an inter-institutional agreement between the University and the host employer, it additionally requires prior review and endorsement by the University's Office of Legal Affairs, which verifies the terms of the agreement before the internship is formally recognized and credited.

Accordingly, and in strict application of the procedure described above, the internship undertaken by Mr. Rivera Benavides in Germany under the KOSPIE 2025–2026 program is, upon compliance with the corresponding institutional requirements, formally recognized within his academic record as credit toward two elective course spaces of the Civil Engineering plan de estudios, and not as a stand-alone or purely voluntary activity outside the curriculum.



Accordingly, and in strict application of the procedure described above, provided that Mr. Rivera Benavides duly completes the corresponding institutional process, including review and approval by the Committee on Professional Practices and Internships and endorsement by the University's Office of Legal Affairs, his internship in Germany under the KOSPIE 2025–2026 program will be formally recognized within his academic record as credit toward two elective course spaces of the Civil Engineering, and not as a stand-alone or purely voluntary activity outside the curriculum.

We trust this clarification provides the Agency with an accurate and transparent account of the academic framework applicable to Mr. Rivera Benavides' internship. The Faculty remains available to provide any additional information or supporting documentation the Agency may require.

Kind regards,

Miguel Mauricio CASTILLA BARBOSA, Dr. Ing
Dean - Faculty of Civil Engineering
Universidad Santo Tomás, Seccional Bogotá D.C.
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